

Action bar

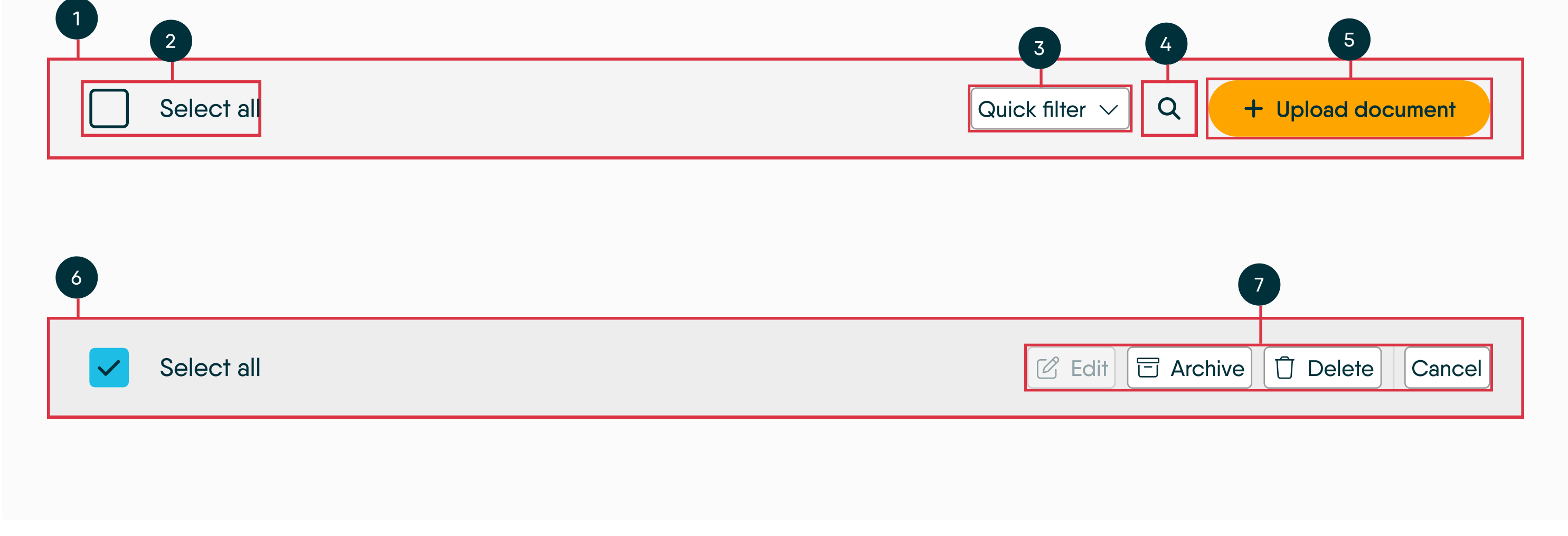
Action bars serve as a central hub for users to access and perform actions within an interface.

Introduction

Action bars are a useful component that can be integrated with other existing components, allowing users to efficiently perform actions on one or multiple items simultaneously. Action bars emphasise clarity by presenting a concise set of actions, ensuring that the most important and frequently used actions are prominently displayed.

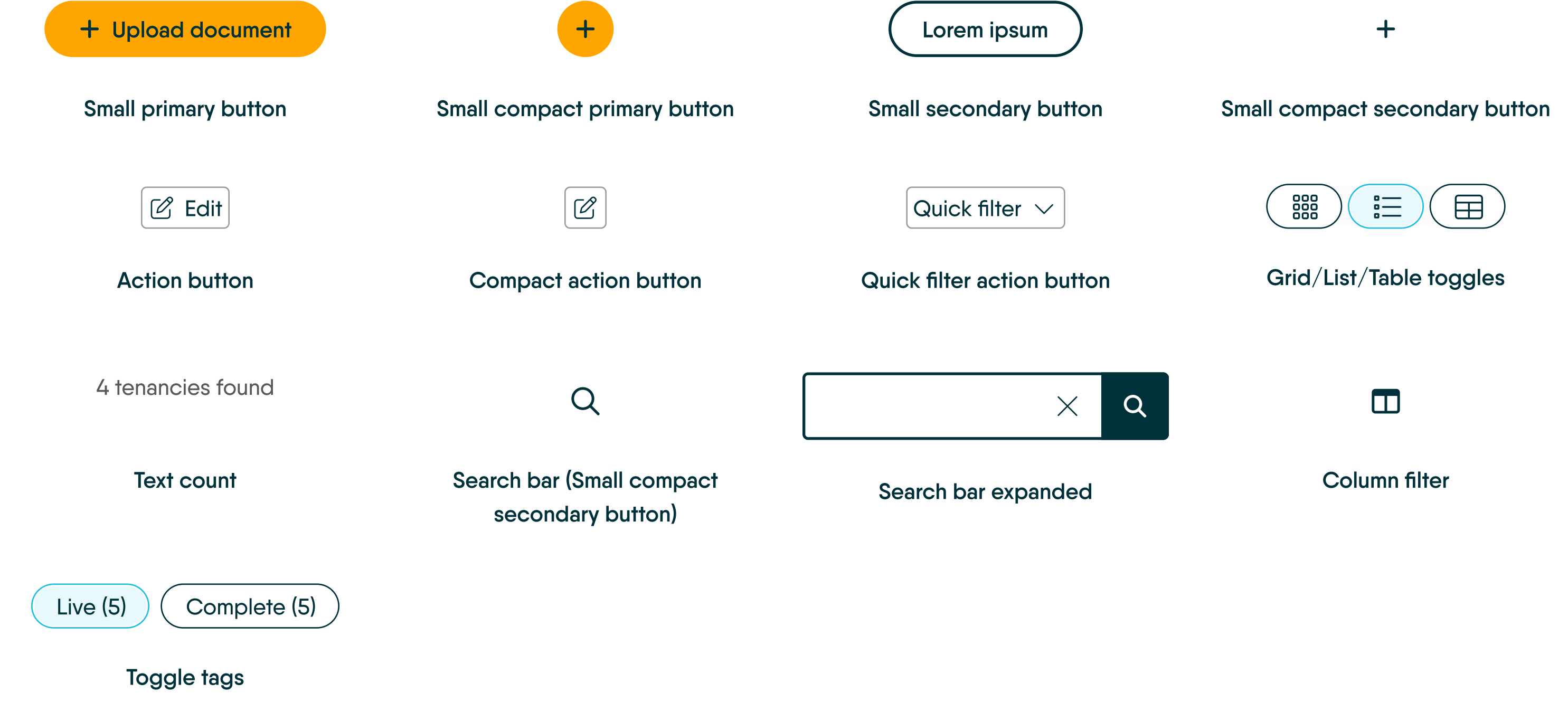
Defined by it's compact design and responsive overflow options, the micro-component rich action bar is viable in already busy interfaces and on smaller screens.

Anatomy



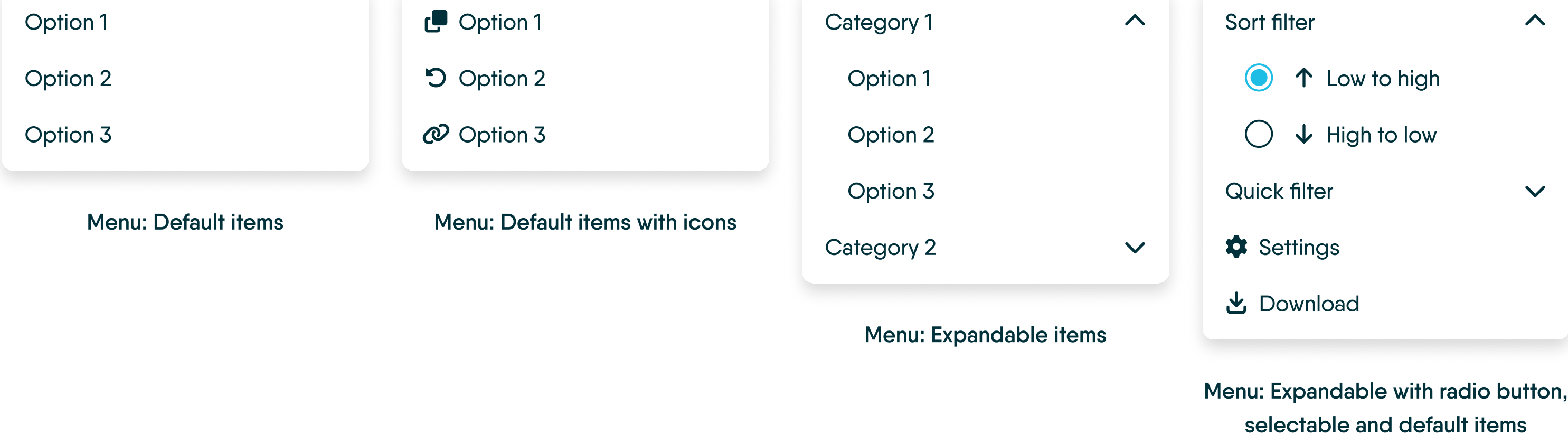
- 1. Default state container
- 2. Select box (optional)
- 3. Filter/Sort by (optional)
- 4. Secondary compact button (optional)
- 5. Primary button (optional)
- 6. Selected state container (if a Select box is added, the selected state container will appear when one or more items are selected)
- 7. Action button group

Components that can be used in the Action bar



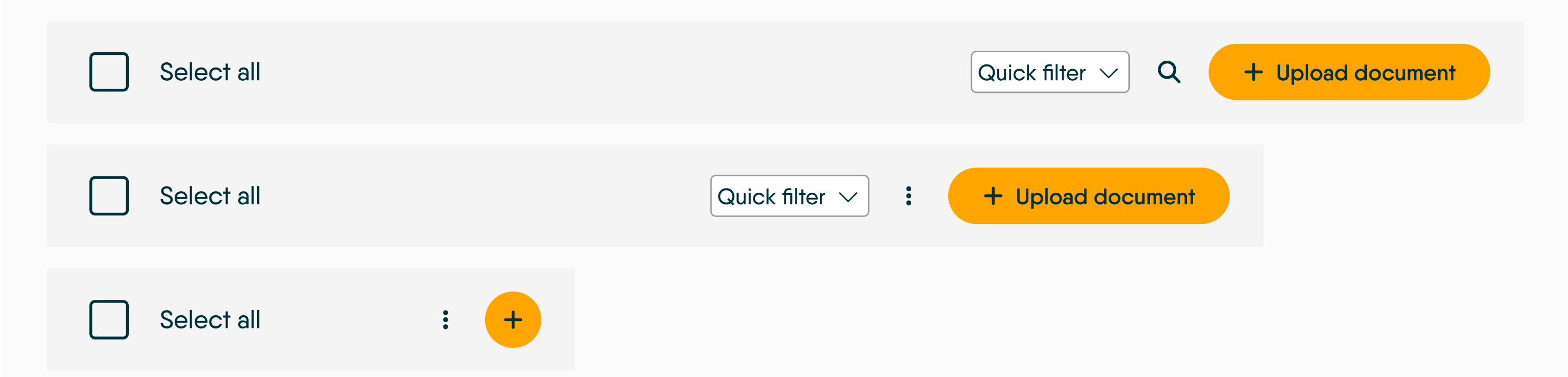
Overflow menu options

Any variant from the [menu](#) styleguide can be used to house overflow options. See some examples below:

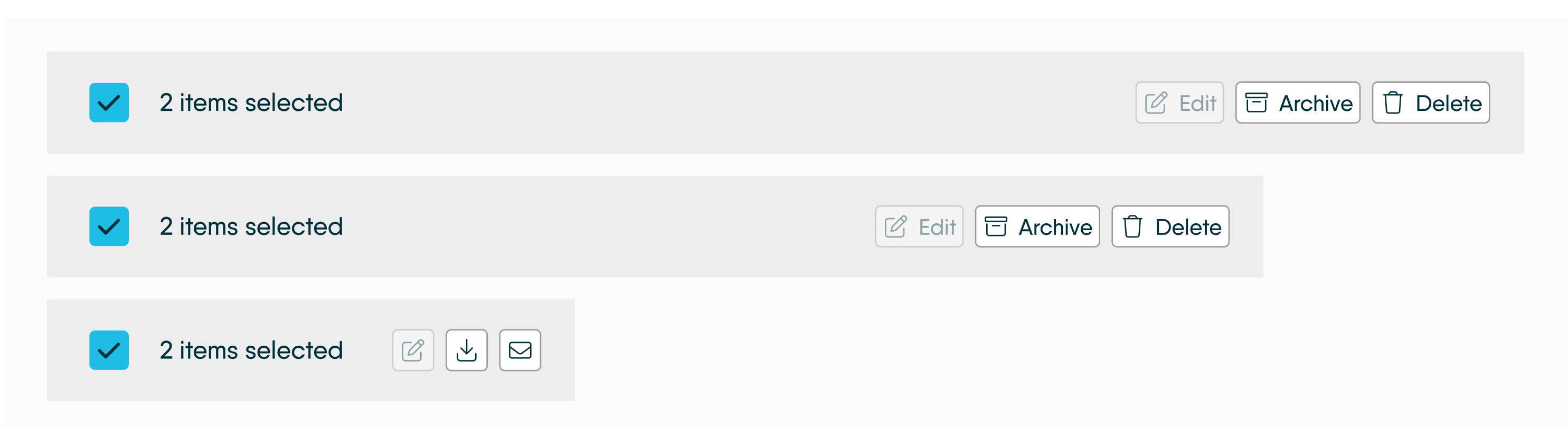


Behaviours

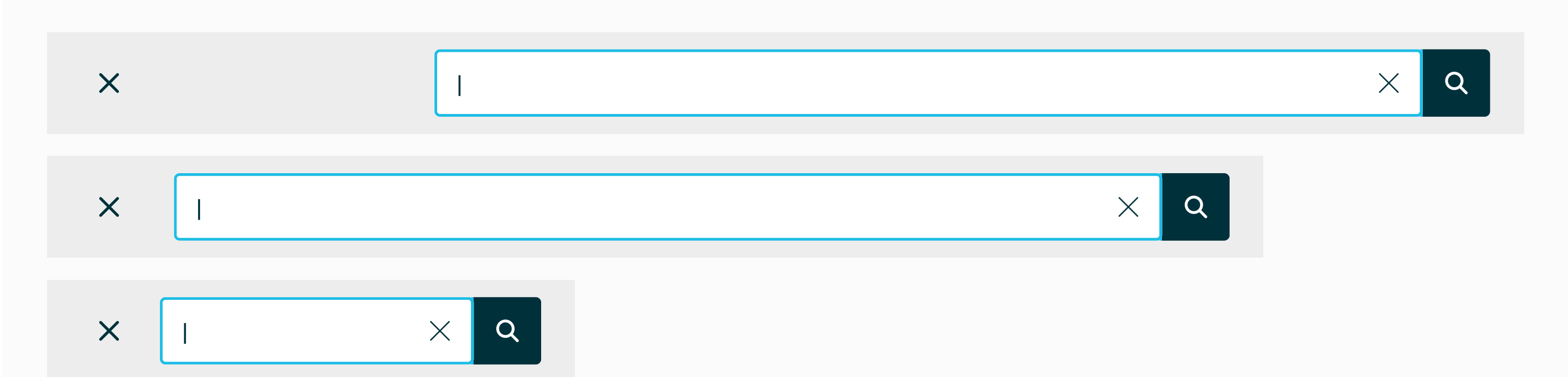
Adaptive displays



Default state



Selected state



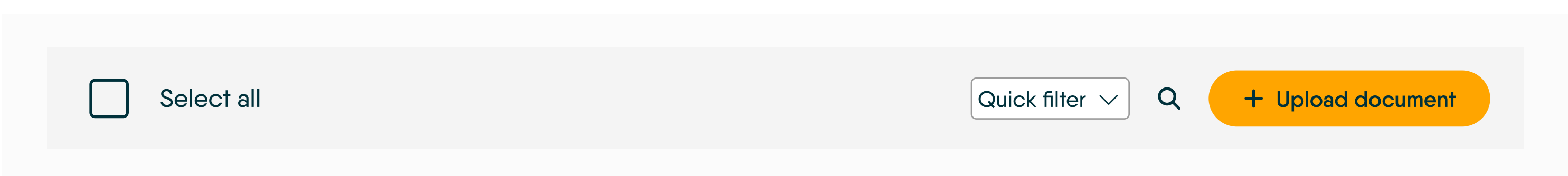
Search state

States

The Action bar has three states: Default, Selected and Search.

Default is the initial (and possibly only, depending on use) state the Action bar takes. Defined by it's lighter background, it's a responsive container that houses buttons and actions that affect the elements its linked to globally, e.g., filtering a table, sorting a list by newest to oldest, etc.

The Default state may not have the 'Select all' checkbox on the left, it could have other components or be empty on the left. It's down to the utility and required functions needed.

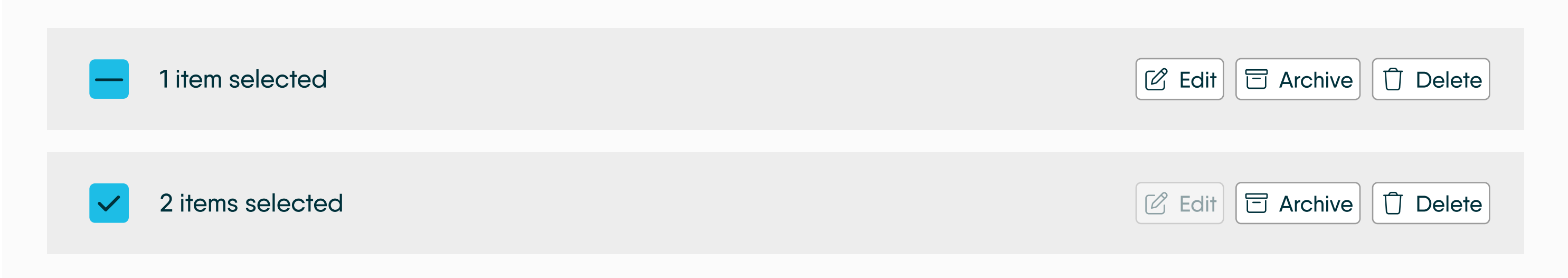


Selected is a secondary state, it only appears when the user selects an item linked to the action bar, overlapping the Default state and presenting a list of actions relevant to the selected item(s). There are Individual and Batch actions:

Individual actions: These are actions that only change a single item. They are disabled when two or more items are selected, e.g. 'Edit'.

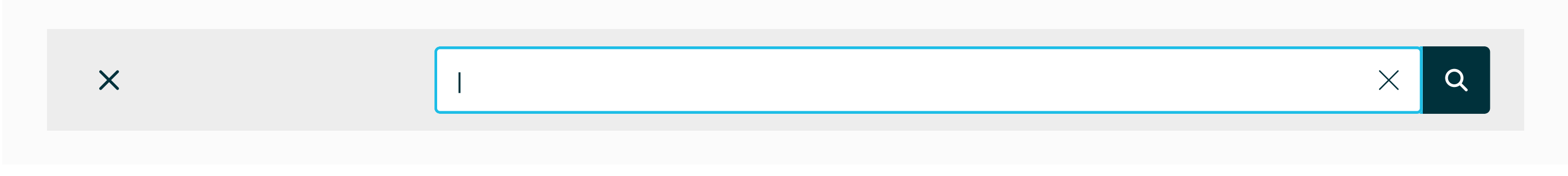
Batch actions: These are actions that can be done 'in batch'. The user can selected as many items as they want and apply a batch action to them and change them simultaneously, e.g. 'Delete', 'Undo', 'Archive'.

Dismissal: The Select state will be dismissed either when the user completes an action and it is no longer needed, or when the user deselects all linked items. In both cases, the Selected state will be hidden and return to the Default state.



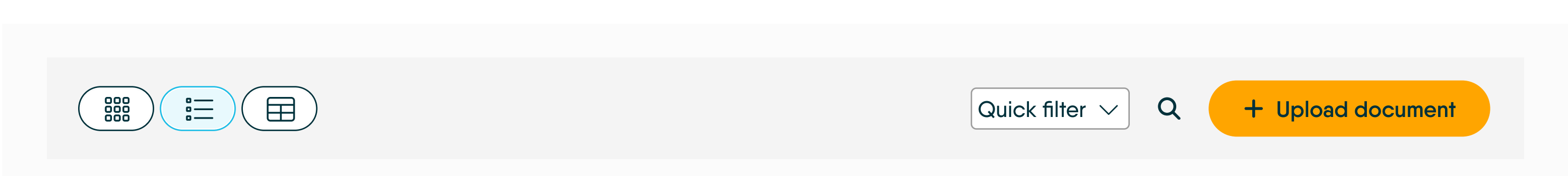
Search is a secondary state, it only appears when the user clicks the 'search' icon, overlapping the Default state and presenting an input field.

Dismissal: On Desktop and Tablet, you can exit the Search state by pressing the 'X' icon or anywhere on the page outside the search bar. On Mobile, You can exit the Search state by pressing anywhere on the page outside the search bar. When dismissed, the Search state will be hidden and return to the Default state.



Switch views

Toggle tags can be used to allow users to switch views.



Selected state: active area

The active area around the select box in the default state is kept tight around the select box. Users must directly click on the select box to trigger the Selected state. Other elements sharing the same container in the item can be interacted with, e.g. an 'Open link' button in a card or a text link within a table row.

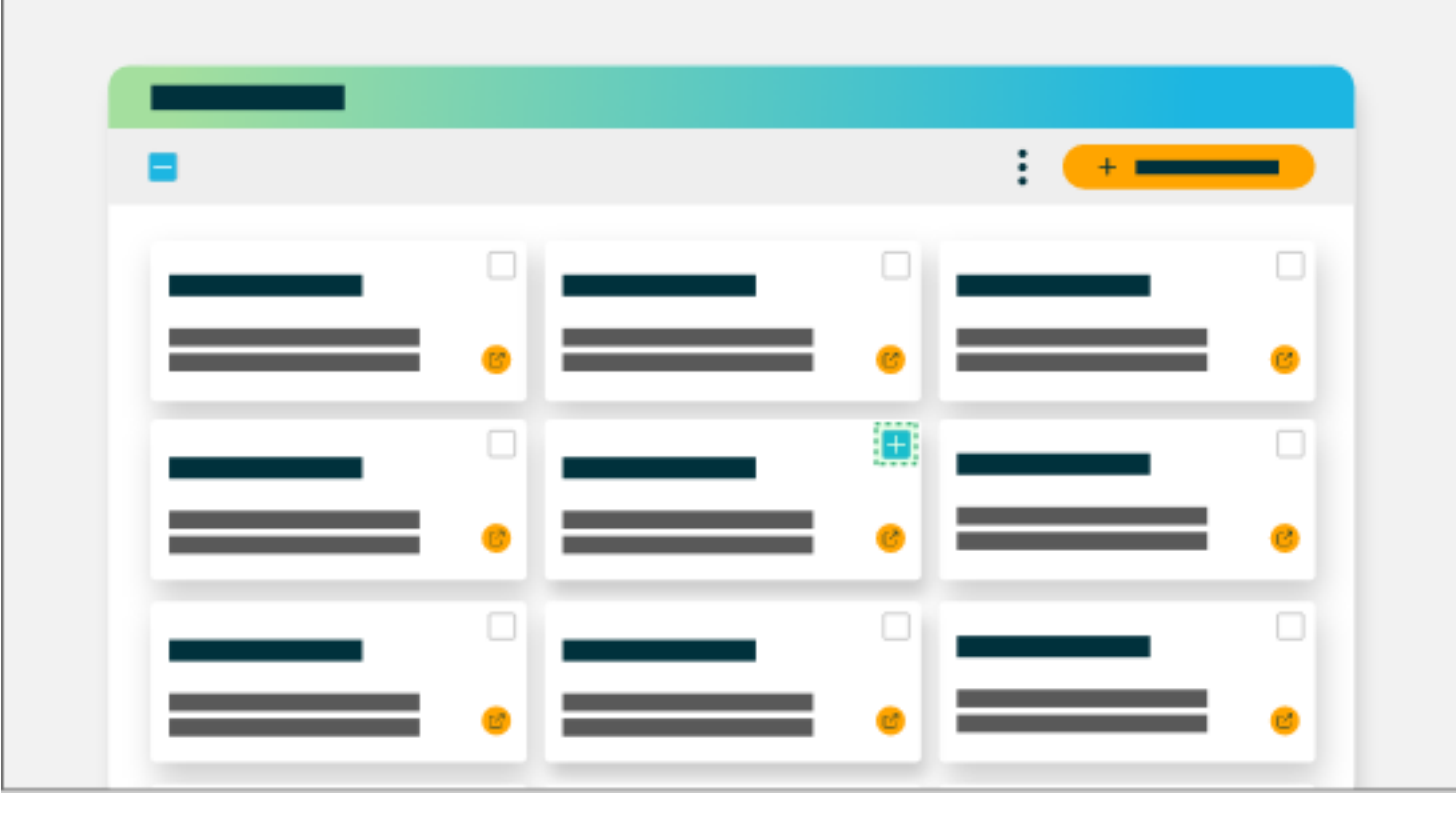
When the user selects an item from the linked list, the active area expands to cover a larger area, making it quicker and easier to select and deselect individual items. Users can click on anywhere within the expanded active area to select/deselect that item. Other elements sharing the same container in the item can no longer interacted with until the Selected state returns to default and the active area on each of the list items shrinks to their default size.



Table list: Active area around select box, default state



Table list: Expanded active area around select box, selected state



Card list: Active area around select box, default state

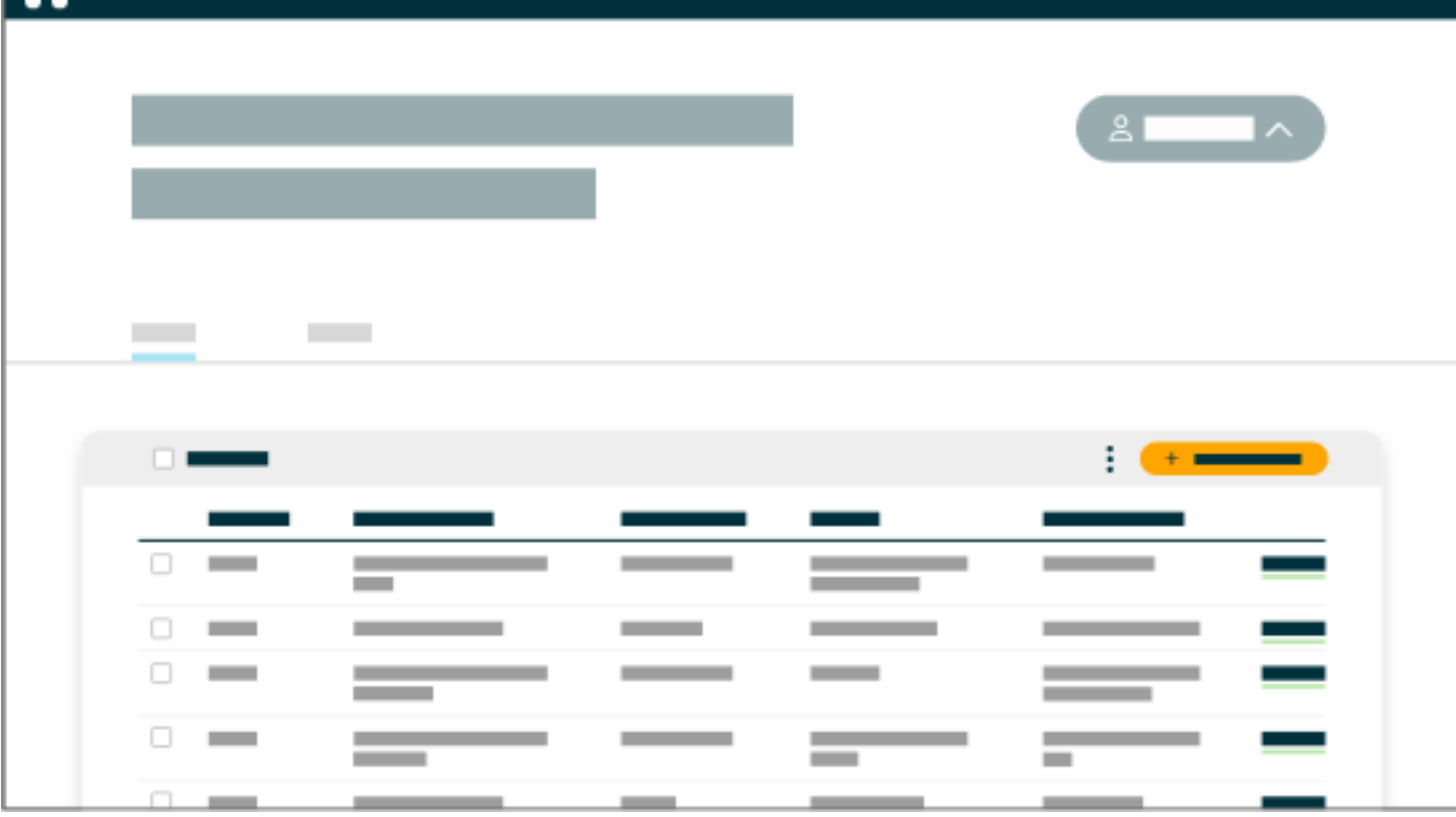


Card list: Expanded active area around select box, selected state

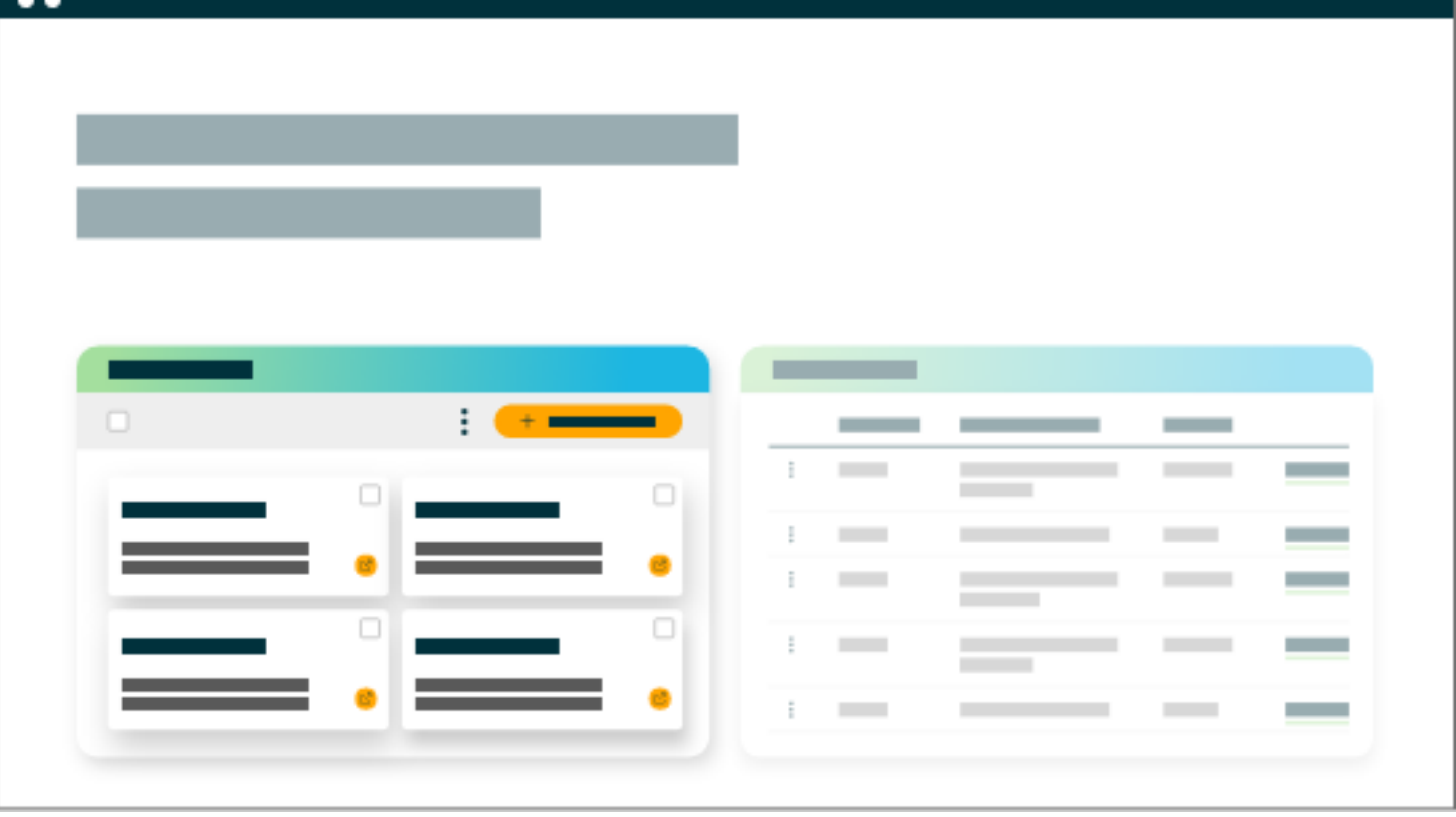
Examples of use

The Action bar is a flexible component that can be used in a broad range of applications and context. With optional components within the Action bar that can be swapped in and out – depending on need – making the Action bar adjustable. Some examples of potential use are displayed below.

Action bars can be used inline next to other content or also full width taking up the entire space.



Add to tables



Add to admin panel



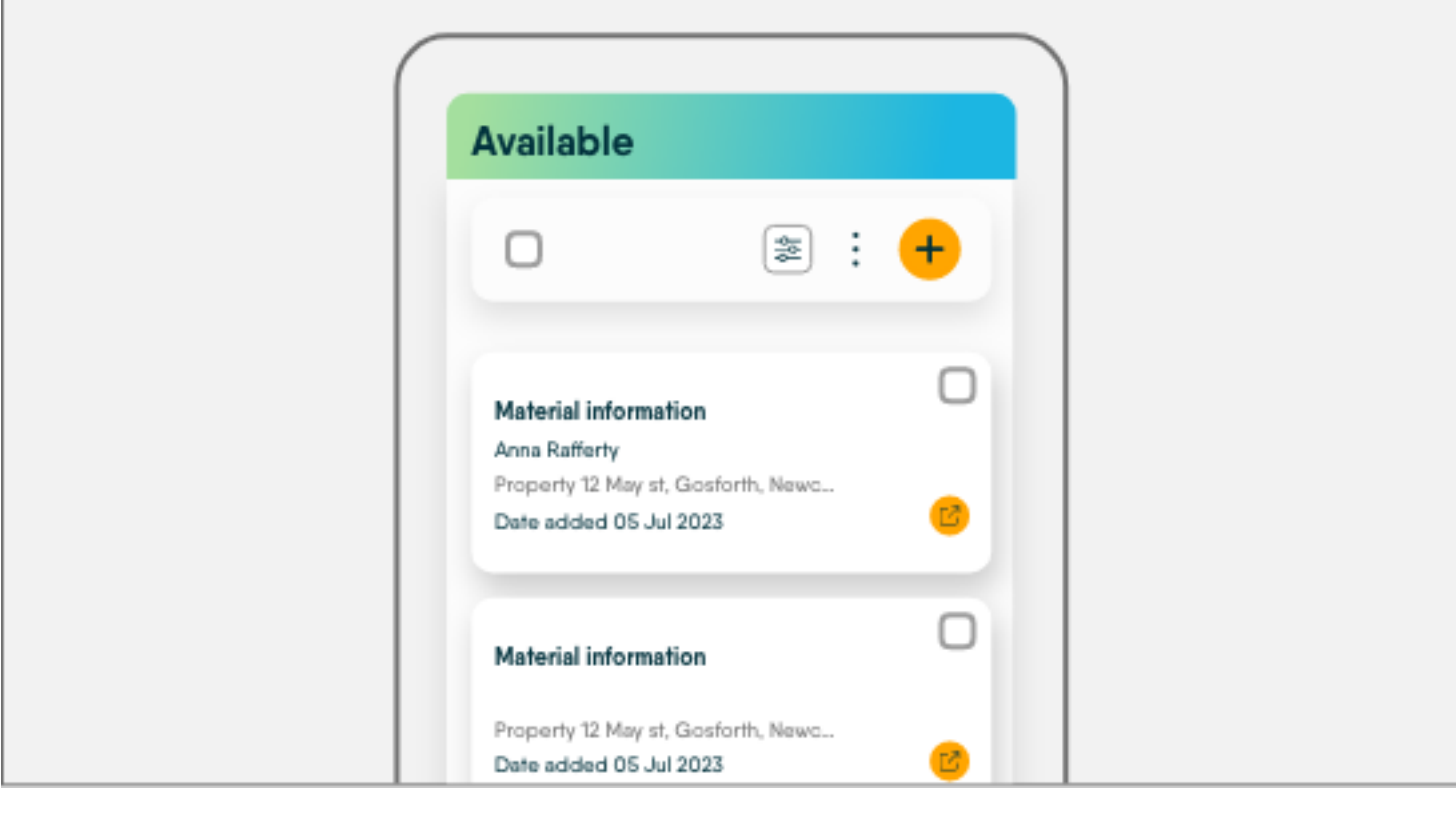
Add to top of page



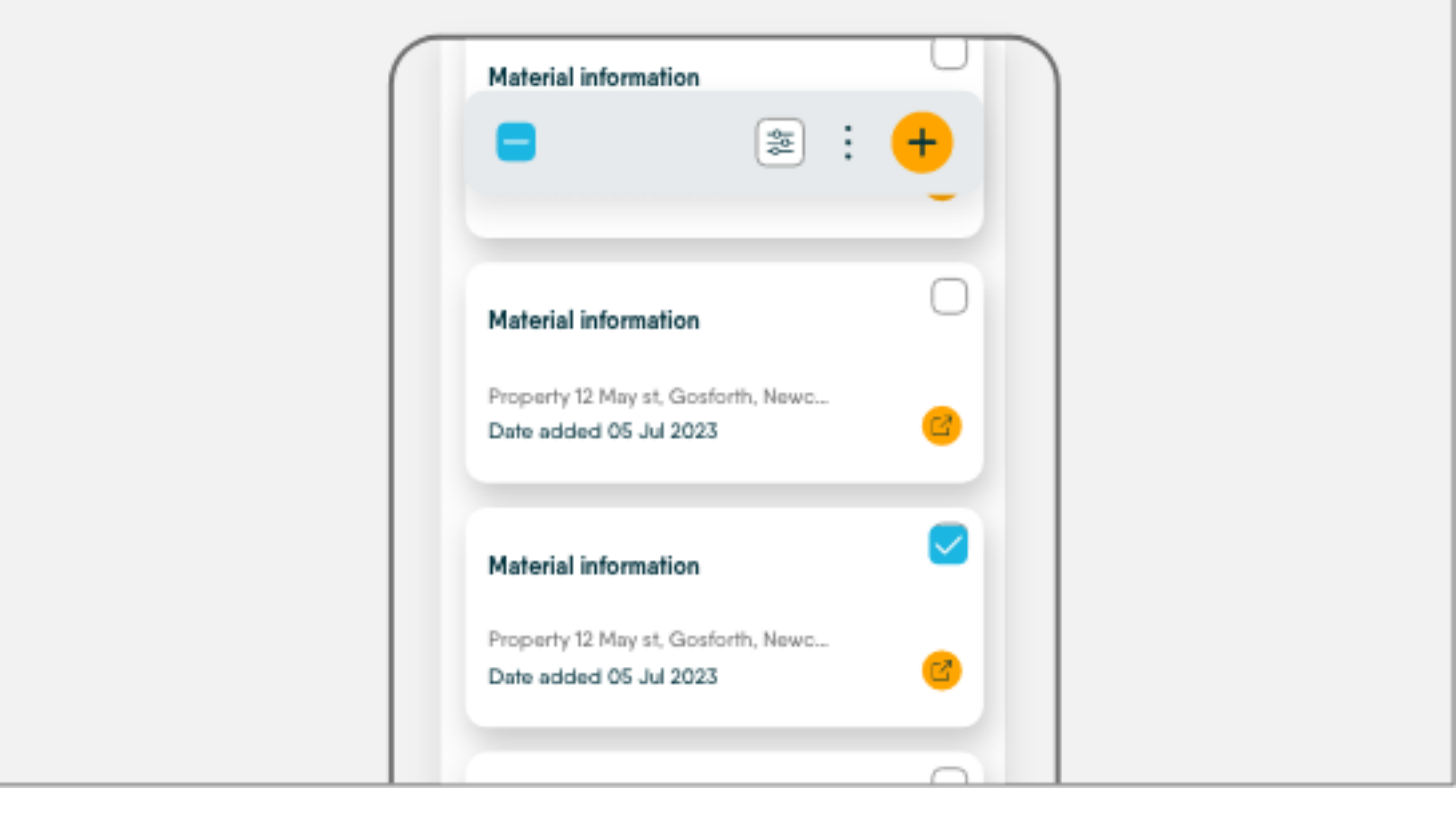
Add to bottom of page

Mobile behaviour

On mobile devices, the action bar collapses to save screen space, condensed into a few key buttons or icons or with an overflow menu with listed actions. To accommodate the mobile table rows or list elements, it becomes sticky and follows the user down the page to ensure action options are always available to the user.



Mobile Action bar

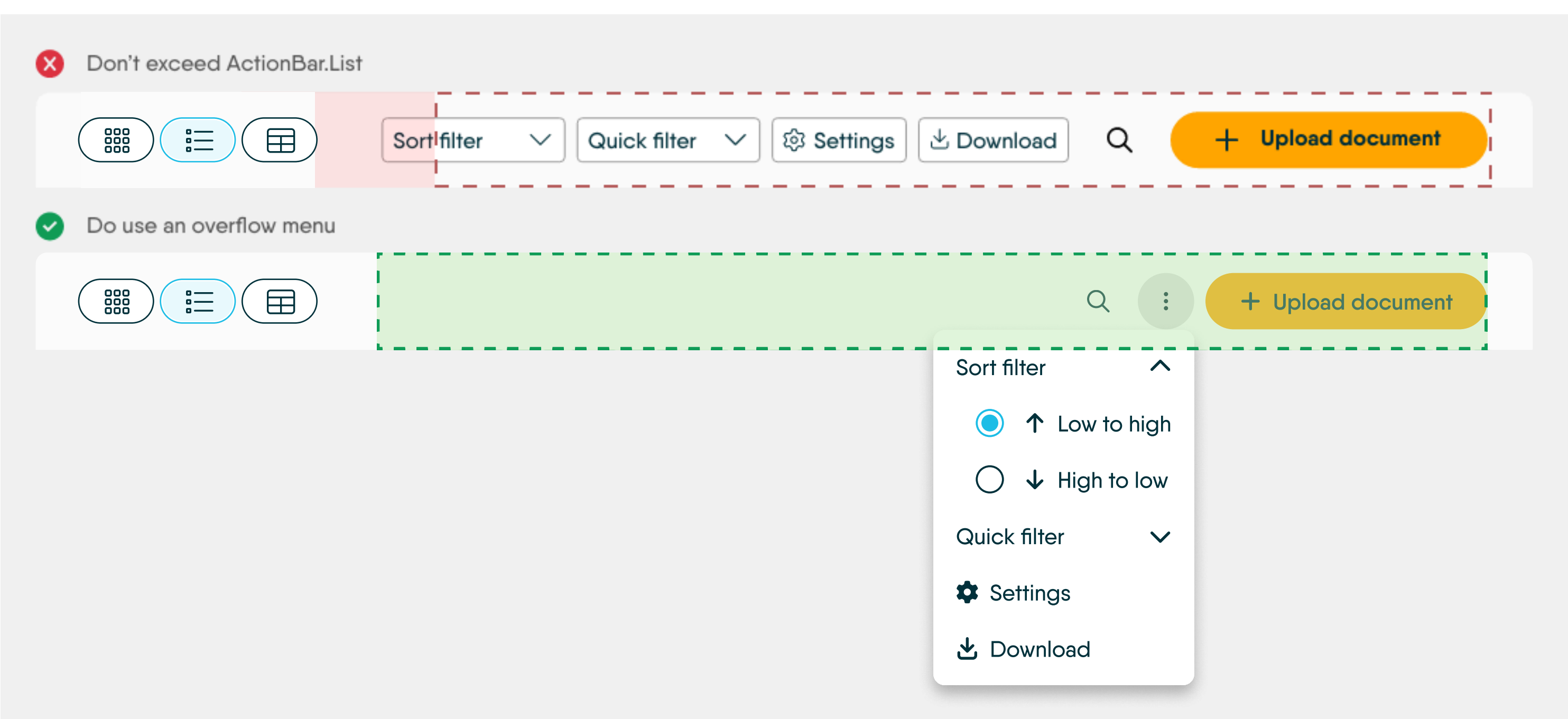


Mobile Action bar - sticky

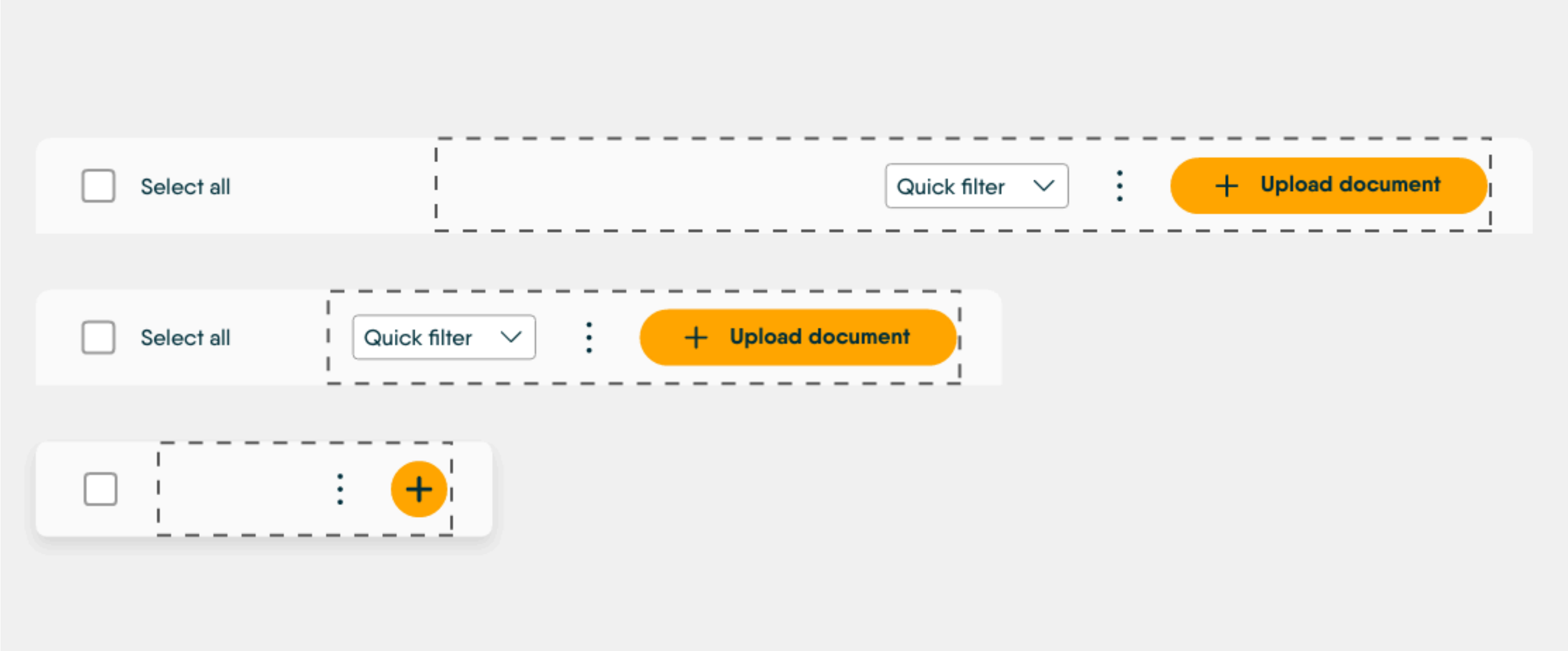
Overflow

Overflow menus are user interface elements that provide a space-efficient way to present additional actions and options that do not fit within the primary interface. Actions within an overflow menu are organised hierarchically or based on categories to enhance user comprehension.

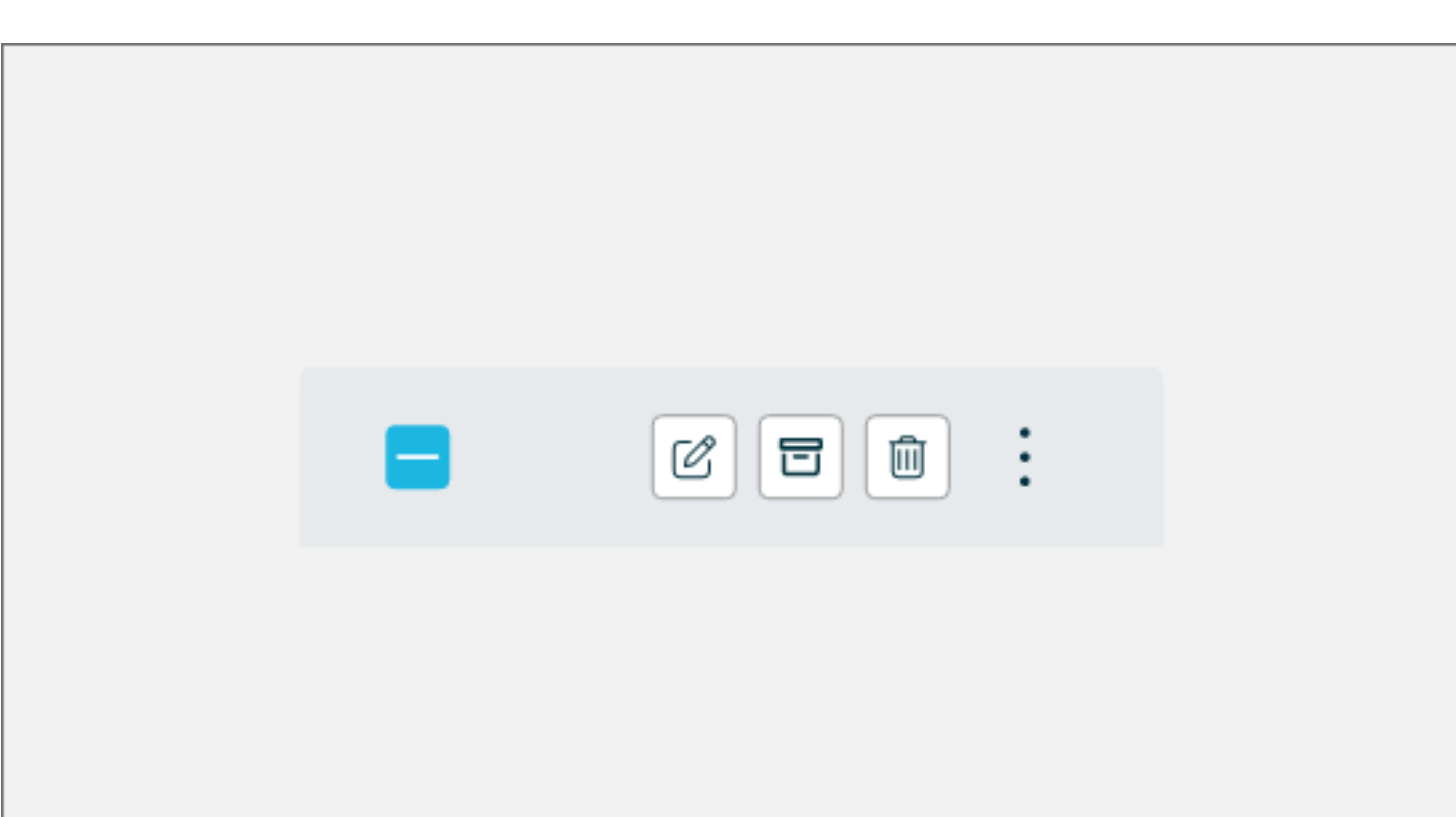
Overflow helps manage actions and maintain a clean user interface while ensuring that users have access to a comprehensive set of options when needed.



Default: When sizing down, the secondary button acts as overflow and actions are grouped together



Responsive: When sizing down across breakpoints, the ActionBar.List will size accordingly

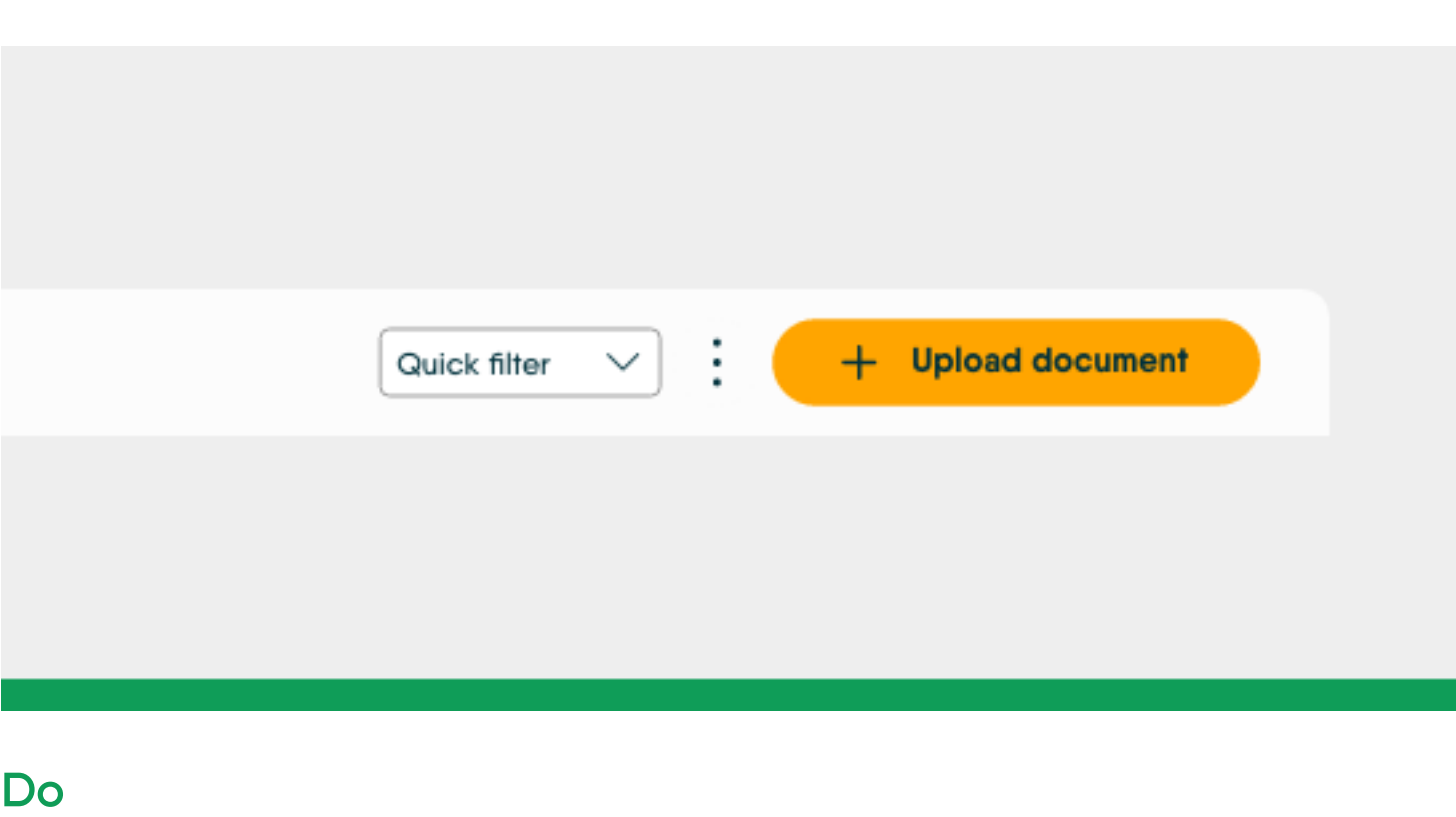


Mobile: Action buttons are made more compact by hiding the text and relying on an icon to convey their meaning and what they do. The ActionBar.List can contain up to three compact action icons. Any more will be added to the overflow menu

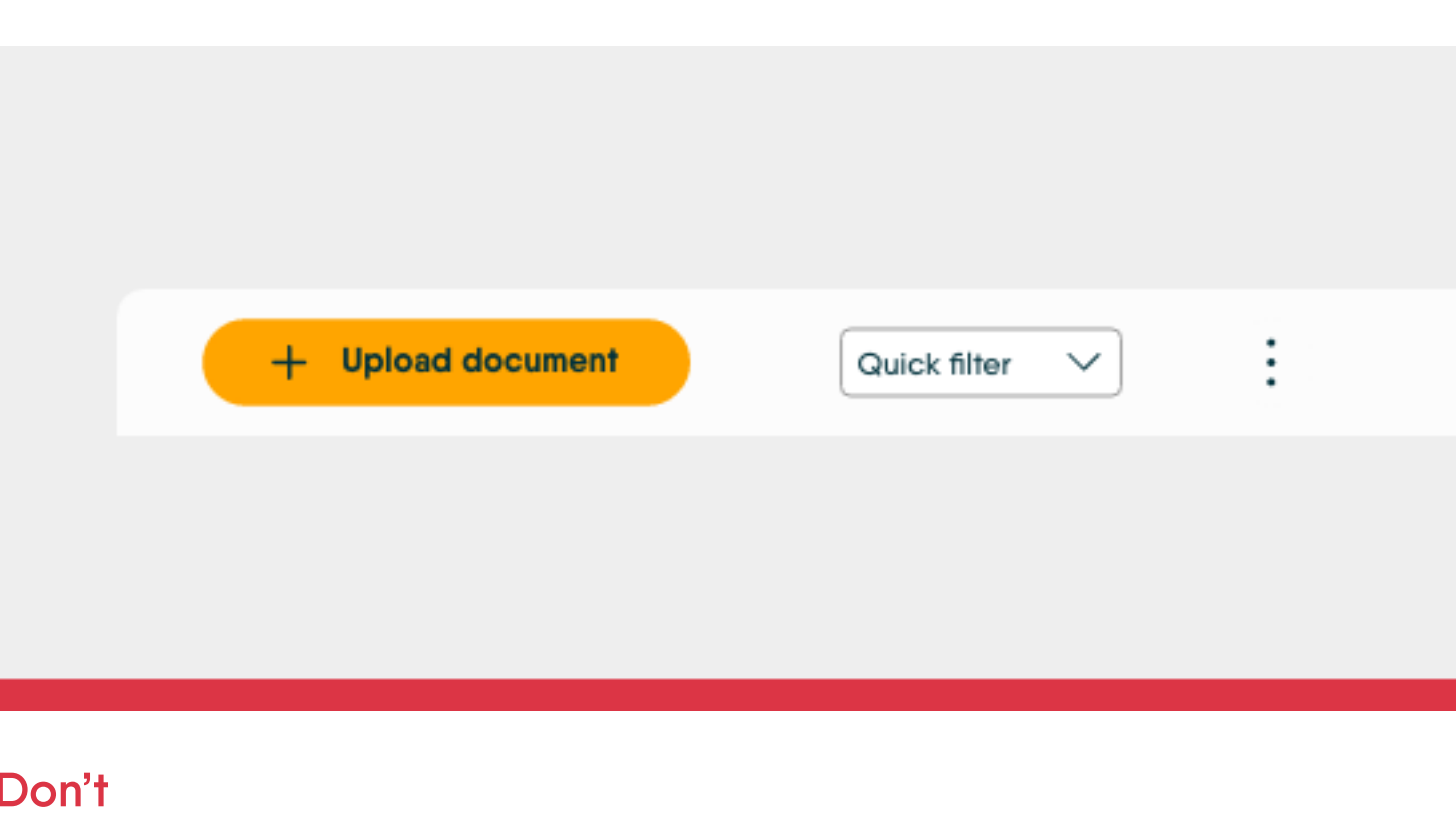
Layout

Action bars can be used inline next to other content, added to the top of existing components or also at the top of a page and linked to a range of content below it.

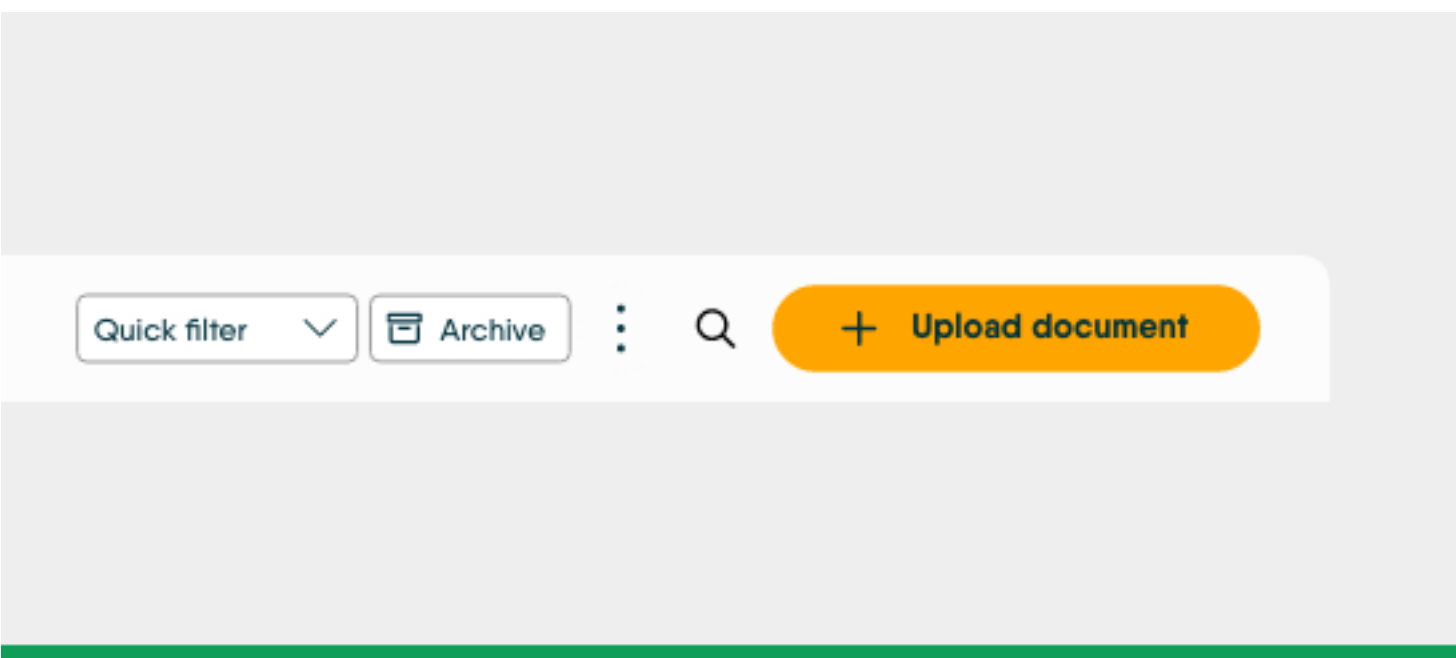
There are two containers in the Action bar, the container to the right (ActionBar.List) has special qualities – see section on Overflow. The ActionBar.List has an alignment to the right. When elements are added to, removed or put into an overflow menu, all the elements within will continue to align right.



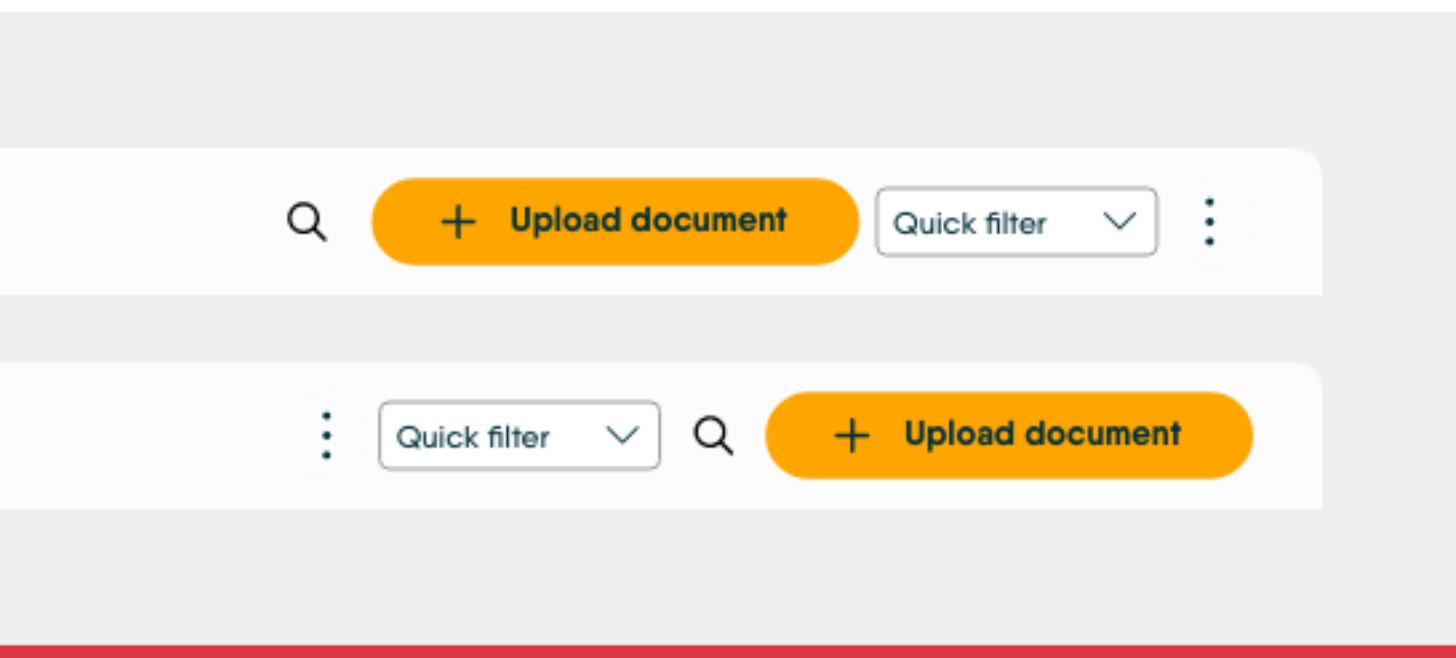
Do
Align all elements to the right.



Don't
Change the alignment, group order or spacing of the elements.



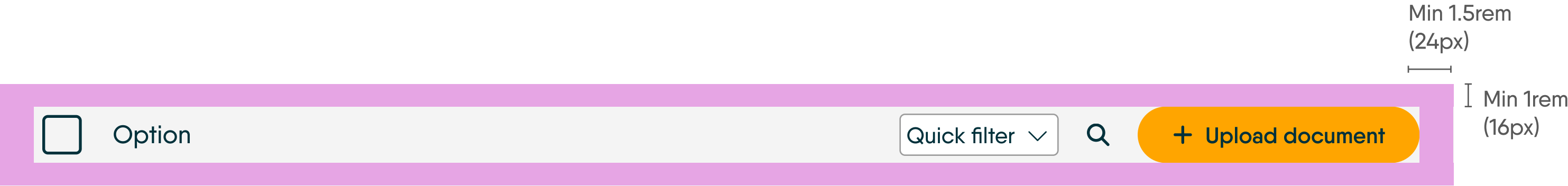
Do
Follow group order. Primary buttons and Secondary buttons are grouped, Action buttons and Quick Filter/Sorts are grouped.



Don't
Don't throw elements in and break the group order. Also, the overflow Secondary button should always be closest to the Action button group.

Dimensions

Container padding



Group spacing



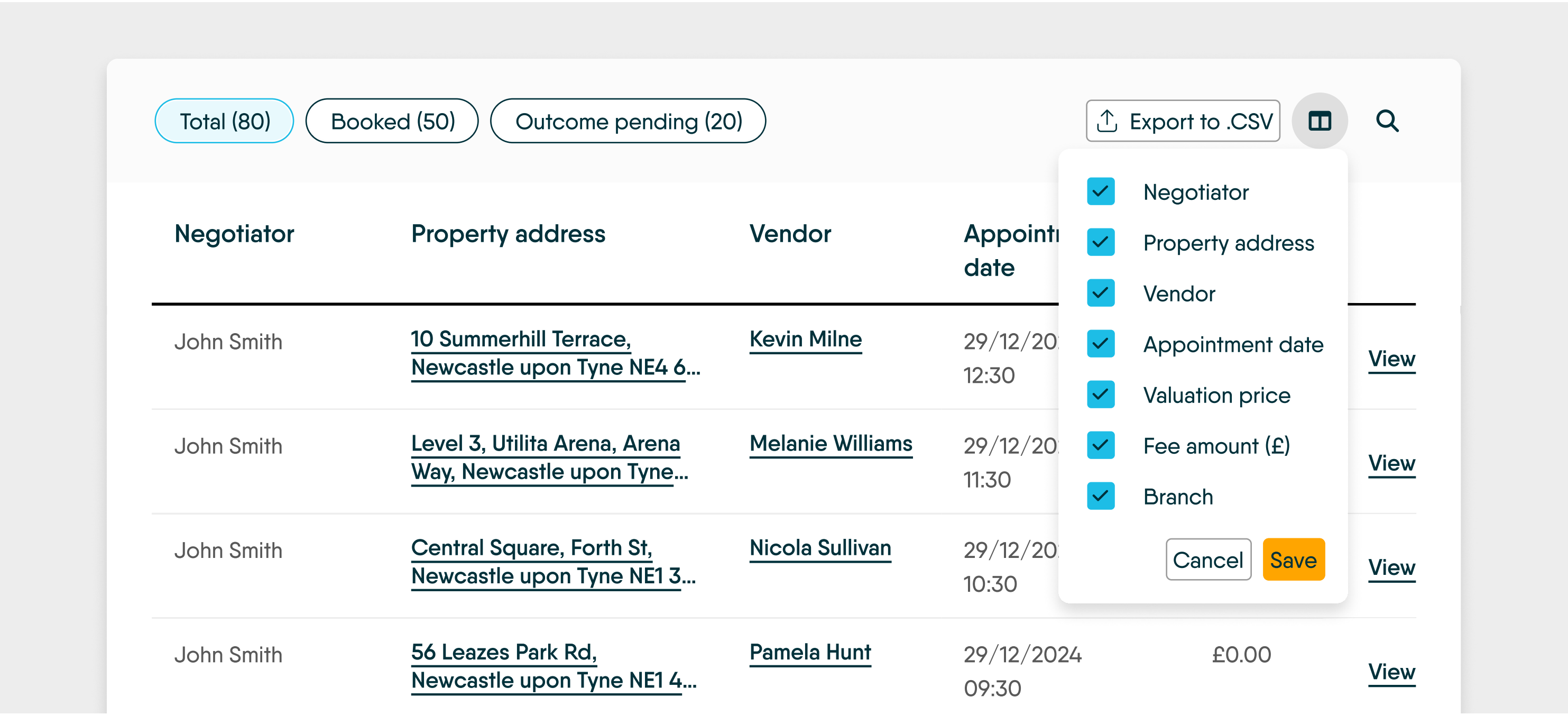
ActionBar.List



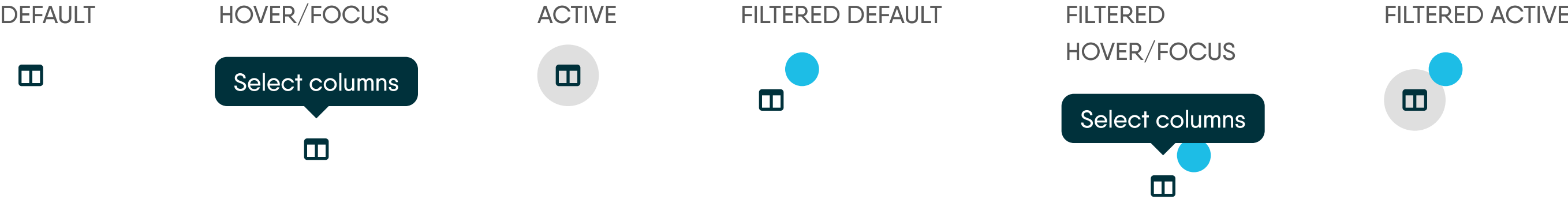
Column filter

When an action bar is used with a table we can add a column filter. The column filter allows the user to customise what columns they show or hide in the table. There should be an option to save this filter so if the user leaves the page and returns the column filter is still applied.

When clicked a dialog (popover or modal) can be displayed to show the column sorting options.



States



Version control:

V1.3 added

Date of design update:

06.11.2025

Notable updates:

- Changed behaviour of search so when clicked it defaults to active to save the user clicking again
- Reduced minimum padding above and below bar to 1rem (16px) and left and right of the bar to 1.5rem (24px) to align with the admin panel
- Changed style of view toggles to match the toggle tag
- Added toggle tags as a usable component in action bar
- Change Figma component to slot component to allow for further customisation of content within the action bar
- Add option to add to bottom of page

V1.2 added

29.10.2025

Updated popovers to menus

V1.1 added

23.8.2023

Added option for column filter and saving column filter.

V1 added

N/A